

control the behaviour of ads, pop-ups, Flash objects, etc. on a per-site basis.

- **Information:** Opera has an information-laden status bar. Unlike other browsers, which just display a progress bar, Opera tells you the page loading status in KB, the URL sending the data, the number of images on the page and how many of them have been loaded, the speed with which the transfer is taking place, and the time taken to load a page. As a result, it is easy to comprehend why certain pages take some time to load.
- **Shortcuts:** Searching for a word in Google requires you to visit the site and then put in the terms. With Opera, you can set a shortcut key for a search engine—any search engine—and search off the address bar! Thus, typing in “g <space> biography gandhi” will take you to the Google results page. Opera comes with a few shortcuts inbuilt, but more can be added. For example, while Dictionary.com is not innately supported, one can have any word looked up by adding the following text in the corresponding box under the Search tab in Preferences:

Name—“Dictionary”, Keyword—“d”, Address—“<http://dictionary.reference.com/browse/%s>”.

Now, to look up any word, just prefix it with “d” and you will be taken to the results page at dictionary.com.

Keyboard shortcuts are available for every browser function, and if that were not enough, movements of the mouse can be used to control the browser. A left drag with the mouse will take you to the previous page. In Opera 9, voice activation features have been added (separate download required).

- **Skins:** The Opera community offers you many user-created themes. To help with the installation, Opera has an integrated skin search-download-apply feature. As an additional time saver, Opera offers a choice of colour schemes that can be applied to each skin, thus multiplying the customisability options. You can get to the feature from **Tools > Appearance > Skins > Find More Skins**, or you can visit <http://my.opera.com/community/customize/skins/>.